

Watson and Crick

The guys who UNCOVERED the secret of life

Watson and Crick were the first to uncover the double helix structure of DNA and unravel what makes us tick.

The dynamic duo

Francis Crick was born in 1916 near Northampton, England. He studied physics, but changed to biology and got a job at **Cambridge University**. James Watson was born in 1928 in Chicago. He wanted to study ornithology (the study of birds), but changed his mind and took **genetics**. He moved to Cambridge University in 1951, where he met Crick. Watson and Crick worked together on studying the **STRUCTURE OF DNA**.

By the way...
until we came along, scientists knew DNA carried genes from one generation to the next, but they didn't know how—or what DNA looked like.

A chromosome is a package of genetic information made up of a very long strand of DNA.

Did you know?

After they made their discovery, Crick walked into the Eagle pub in Cambridge and announced, "We have found the secret of life."

They couldn't have done it without...



GREGOR MENDEL (1822–1884)
started the **SCIENCE OF GENETICS**.
He studied peas and discovered they passed on certain traits to their offspring.



FRIEDRICH MIESCHER (1844–1895)
discovered that **cells** contain **NUCLEIC ACIDS**, which paved the way for the discovery of DNA, a nucleic acid.